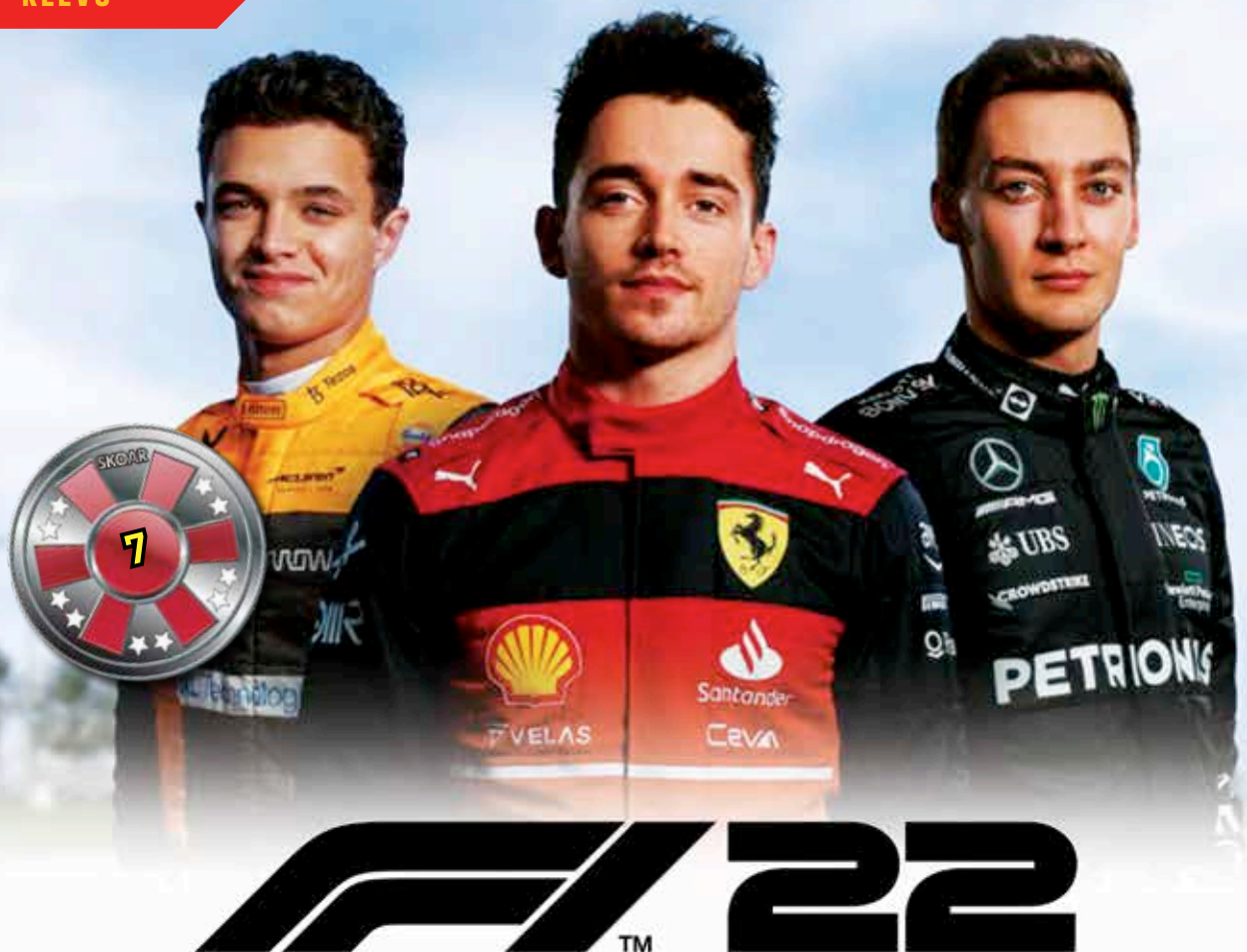




NEW SKIN, OLD GAME?

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The 2022 F1 season has brought a ton of changes to the design and aerodynamics of real-life cars with new rules and regulations designed to improve racing and the following of cars behind other cars. What that means is that the cars now have a different way in which they create downforce and although effective, it's not in the same league as the cars from the previous generation. F1 22 incorporates all the regulation changes of its real-world counterpart and that's evident in the design of the cars.

VISUALS

We played F1 22 on the PlayStation 5. And, as you would expect, the visuals were pretty good. We say pretty good because we didn't get the chance to test the game out on a decked-out PC with a bonkers GPU. While that may

have crushed it in terms of the visuals, the PS5 really didn't leave you wanting. Although it must be said that the visuals were very good when it came to the look of the cars while driving in the "far chase" cam mode and when it came to driving in the "cockpit" cam mode. The details and textures on the driving gloves and the steering wheel were superb. It's a different story when it comes to the other aspects of the game though. For example, the virtual avatars of the drivers, while having some resemblance to their real-life counterparts, looked quite plasticky. It is clear that the devs have put much more effort into the virtual models of the cars and tracks rather than the models of the drivers which is fine. In F1 22 we'd much rather prefer the effort being put to make the car look more realistic than the drivers.

Another issue that we noticed was that the game really didn't offer much in terms of perception of speed. You are there in the fastest racing machines in the world but even at top speed, it doesn't convincingly convey that you are going at a blistering 300+ kmph. A mass appeal game like F1 22 could have done with a bit more in terms of the illusion of speed.

GAMEPLAY

The F1 22 gameplay is quite similar to the previous generation F1 games as you might expect, apart from the slight changes in the handling and downforce of the cars. F1 22 once again toes the line between being a full-on sim racing game and an arcade racing game. Think of F1 22 as a game specifically developed for fans of the F1 sport who want to get in on some of the action and get a taste